Light Tahini Caesar

FROM NELL'S KITCHEN

A healthier take on the classic Caesar salad, featuring juicy air-fried chicken breast with a golden tahini crust, crisp romaine lettuce, homemade crunchy croutons, and a creamy tahini Caesar dressing.

Serves 4–6 · Prep 15 min · Cook 15 min

INGREDIENTS

FOR THE TAHINI CAESAR DRESSING

- 3 tbsp tahini
- 2 tbsp laban (plain yogurt)
- 2 tbsp freshly squeezed lemon juice
- 2 tbsp grated Parmesan cheese
- 2 tbsp extra virgin olive oil
- Salt and freshly ground black pepper, to taste

FOR THE CHICKEN

- 2 chicken breasts
- 2–3 tbsp tahini
- 1 tbsp olive oil
- 1 tsp smoked paprika
- Salt and freshly ground black pepper, to taste

FOR THE HOMEMADE CROUTONS

- 3–4 slices of bread, cut into sticks
- 1–2 tbsp olive oil
- A pinch of salt

FOR THE SALAD

- 2 heads romaine lettuce
- Extra grated Parmesan cheese, for serving
- Freshly ground black pepper, to finish

METHOD

PREPARE THE DRESSING

1. In a bowl, whisk together the tahini, laban, lemon juice, grated Parmesan, and olive oil until smooth and creamy. Season with salt and freshly ground black pepper. If the dressing is too thick, add a little water until you reach your desired consistency. Set aside.

PREPARE THE CHICKEN

2. Coat the chicken breasts with tahini, olive oil, smoked paprika, salt, and pepper, making sure they are evenly covered.
3. Place the chicken breasts in the air fryer at 200°C for approximately 12–15 minutes, depending on their thickness, until beautifully golden and cooked through (74°C in the center).
4. Allow the chicken to rest for a few minutes before slicing. The tahini creates a delicious golden crust while keeping the chicken juicy and tender.

PREPARE THE HOMEMADE CROUTONS

5. Cut the bread into sticks and toss with olive oil and a pinch of salt.
6. Arrange in the air fryer at 180°C for approximately 5–7 minutes, shaking halfway through, until golden and crispy. Set aside to cool.

PREPARE THE LETTUCE

7. Wash the romaine lettuce thoroughly and dry well. Chop into generous bite-sized pieces, keeping the leaves crisp and fresh.

ASSEMBLE THE SALAD

8. Place the romaine lettuce in a large salad bowl and toss gently with the tahini Caesar dressing until evenly coated.
9. Arrange the sliced chicken breasts over the lettuce and scatter the crunchy homemade croutons around the salad.
10. Finish with a generous amount of freshly grated Parmesan cheese and a sprinkle of black pepper.
11. Serve immediately.

Tip

A lighter, wholesome twist on a timeless classic, without compromising on flavor.